

The BIOS is typically placed in a ROM chip that comes with the computer. This ensures that the BIOS will always be available and will not be damaged by disk failures. It also makes it possible for a computer to boot itself. Many modern PCs have a Flash BIOS, which means that the BIOS has been recorded on a Flash memory chip, which can be updated if necessary.

Driver

Software that defines the characteristics of a device for use by another device or other software.

Socket 7

The form factor for fifth-generation CPU chips from AMD, Cyrix and Intel. All Pentium chips except Intel's Pentium Pro (Socket 8) and Pentium II (Slot 1) conform to Socket 7 specifications. Intel phased out Socket 7 and replaced it with Slot 1. But AMD and Cyrix are sticking with Socket 7, and are also developing an enhanced version.

Socket 8

The form factor for Intel's Pentium Pro processors. The Pentium Pro was the first microprocessor not to use Socket 7. Pentium II processors use the newer Slot 1 form factor.

Socket 8 is a 387-pin socket with connections for the CPU and one or two SRAM dies for the L2 cache.

Slot 1

The form factor for Intel's Pentium II processors. It replaces the Socket 7 and Socket 8 form factors used by previous Pentium processors. Slot 1 is a 242-contact slot that accepts a microprocessor packaged as a Single Edge Contact cartridge. A motherboard can have one or two Slot 1 slots.

Slot 2

A chip packaging design used in Intel's Pentium II chipsets, starting with the Xeon CPU. While the Slot 1 interface features a 242-